

Dr. Javier Sanz-Cruzado Puig

Personal Details

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Professional Experience

Post-doctoral Research Associate

Since November 2021

Information Retrieval Group, IDA Section, School of Computing Science
University of Glasgow, Scotland, United Kingdom

- Text classification and information extraction from biomedical literature.
- Research on recommender systems in the financial domain, portfolio optimization, knowledge graphs and profitability forecasting.
- Development of an investment recommendation platform for its use within the National Bank of Greece.
- Market analysis of the commercialization capabilities of the developed financial recommendation technologies.
- Primary investigator of two EPSRC research associate-led IAA innovation projects.
- Organization of the weekly Information Retrieval reading group.

PhD Student

June 2015 to May 2021

Information Retrieval Group
Universidad Autónoma de Madrid, Spain

- Research on people recommendation in social networks, social network analysis (link prediction, structural metrics, information diffusion), recommendation objectives beyond accuracy and multi-armed bandits for recommendation.

Visiting researcher

May 2019 to July 2019

Information Retrieval Group
University of Glasgow, Scotland, United Kingdom

- Research on information retrieval models for contact recommendation in social networks.
- **Supervisors:** Prof. Craig Macdonald and Prof. Iadh Ounis.

Programmer

June 2013 to August 2013

Every View S.L., Madrid, Spain
Spanish Language Route Project

- Development of the project webpage, using Joomla, MySQL and PHP, mainly web services and payment platforms.
- Development of computer game functionalities, using Unity3D and C#.

Education

PhD in Computer Science and Telecommunications

October 2016 to May 2021

Universidad Autónoma de Madrid

PhD thesis: “[Contact Recommendation in Social Networks: algorithmic models, diversity and network evolution](#)”.

Score: Outstanding (*Cum Laude* mention)

Supervisor: Prof. Pablo Castells

MSc in ICT Research and Innovation

September 2015 to February 2017

Universidad Autónoma de Madrid

Specialization: Computational Intelligence

GPA: 9.32/10

4 Mentions of Honor: “Information Retrieval”, “Machine Learning: Theory and Applications”, “Numerical and data intensive computing” and “Temporal Information Processing”.

MSc Thesis: “[Contact recommendation: Effects on the evolution of social networks](#)”

MSc in Computer Science

September 2015 to February 2017

Universidad Autónoma de Madrid

GPA: 9.52/10

4 Mentions of Honor: “Advanced topics in Networking and Internet”, “Embedded, distributed and ubiquitous systems”, “Graphics, Multimedia and Virtual Environments”, “Interactive Systems Development”.

Double BSc in Computer Science and Mathematics

September 2010 to June 2015

Universidad Autónoma de Madrid

GPA: 9.23/10 (ranked in top 3% of my year)

28 Mentions of honor: including “Artificial Intelligence”, “Neurocomputing”, “Information Search and Mining” and “Fundamentals of Machine Learning”.

BSc Thesis: “Metasearch engine with session management and interleaving A/B testing”.

Grants, Scholarships and Awards

PhD scholarship (FPU Grant), Spanish Government.

September 2018 – May 2021

PhD scholarship (FPI Grant), Universidad Autónoma de Madrid.

March 2017 – September 2018

Research scholarship in MSc studies, Universidad Autónoma de Madrid.

October 2015 – October 2016

Excellence scholarship in BSc Studies, Government of Madrid.

2012 – 2015 (every year)

Research Interests

Information Retrieval: recommender systems, evaluation, novelty, and diversity.

Natural language processing: text classification, information extraction, large language models.

Networks and graphs: analysis, link prediction, information diffusion.

Reinforcement learning: multi-armed bandits.

Financial technologies: profitability forecasting, robo-advisors, portfolio optimization.

Technical Skills

Programming languages: Python, Java, C, PHP, MatLab.

Libraries and frameworks: pyTorch, HuggingFace, Pandas, vLLM, scikit-learn

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, QuestDB, Neo4j.

Operating systems: Microsoft Windows (XP, Vista, 7, 8, 10, 11), Unix (Ubuntu, CentOS).

Software management and deployment: Maven, Git, Docker, Kubernetes (OpenShift).

General purpose software: LaTeX, Overleaf, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel & PowerPoint).

Publications

An updated list of publications and resources related to these publications (pre-prints, slides, posters, videos, code) can be accessed from <https://javier sanz cruz a.github.io/pubs>.

Journal publications

- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R., Droukas, N., Macdonald, C., Ounis, I. Investors Are (Not) Always Right: A Comparison of Transaction-Based and Profitability-Based Metrics for Financial Asset Recommendation. *ACM Transactions on Information Systems*, December 2025, TBP.
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Castells, P., Macdonald, C., Ounis, I. Effective Contact Recommendation in Social Networks by Adaptation of Information Retrieval Models. *Information Processing & Management*, 57(5), Article 102285, September 2020, <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ipm.2020.102285>

Conference publications

- Guo, L., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R. Selecting the Right Experts: Generalizing Information Extraction for Unseen Scenarios via Task-Aware Expert Weighting. *28th European Conference on Artificial Intelligence (ECAI 2025)*. Bologna, Italy, October 2025, pp. 4161-4168, <https://doi.org/10.3233/FAIA251308>
- Takayanagi, T., Izumi, K., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R., Ounis, I. Are Generative AI Agents Effective Personalized Financial Advisors? *48th ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval (SIGIR 2025)*, Padua, Italy, July 2025, pp. 286-295, <https://doi.org/10.1145/3726302.3729897>
- Sánchez, P., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Bellogín, A. Improving novelty and diversity of nearest-neighbors recommendation by exploiting dissimilarities. *47th European Conference on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2025)*. IR4Good track. Lucca, Italy, April 2025, Vol. IV, pp. 187-186, https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-88717-8_14
- Lee, Y., Kim, Y., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R., Lee, Y. Stock Recommendations for Individual Investors: A Temporal Graph Network Approach with Mean-Variance Efficient Sampling. *5th ACM Conference on AI in Finance (ICAIF 2024)*. New York, USA, November 2024, pp. 795-803, <https://doi.org/10.1145/3677052.3698662>
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Castells, P. RELISON: A Framework for Link Recommendation in Social Networks. *45th International ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval (SIGIR 2022)*. Resource track. Madrid, Spain, July 2022, pp. 2992-3002, <https://doi.org/10.1145/3477495.3531730>
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Macdonald, C. Ounis, I., Castells, P. Axiomatic Analysis of Contact Recommendation Methods in Social Networks: an IR Perspective. *42nd European Conference on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2020)*. Online, April 2020, pp. 175-190, https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-45439-5_12
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Castells, P., López, E. A simple multi-armed nearest-neighbor bandit for interactive recommendation. *13th ACM Conference on Recommender Systems (RecSys 2019)*. Copenhagen, Denmark, September 2019, pp. 358-362 <https://doi.org/10.1145/3298689.3347040>
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Castells, P. Information Retrieval Models for Contact Recommendation in Social Networks. *41st European Conf. on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2019)*. Cologne, Germany, April 2019, pp. 148-163, https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-15712-8_10
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Castells, P. Enhancing Structural Diversity in Social Networks by Recommending Weak Ties. *12th ACM Conference on Recommender Systems (RecSys 2018)*. Vancouver, Canada, October 2018, pp. 233-240, <https://doi.org/10.1145/3240323.3240371>

- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Pepa, S.M., Castells, P. Recommending Contacts in Social Networks Using Information Retrieval Models. *5th Spanish Conference on Information Retrieval (CERI 2018)*. Zaragoza, Spain, June 2018, pp. 19:1-19:8, <https://doi.org/10.1145/3230599.3230619>

Conference tutorials

- Lever, J., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Meng, Z. Biomedical text mining for knowledge extraction. *33rd Conference on Intelligent Systems for Molecular Biology (ISMB 2025)*. Tutorial. Liverpool, United Kingdom, July 2025. Without publication.
- Chen, C., Lee, Y., Lopez-Lira, A., Choi, C., McCreadie, R., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.** Information Retrieval in Finance: Industry and Academic Perspectives on Innovation. *48th ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval (SIGIR 2025)*. Tutorial Track. Padua, Italy, July 2025, pp. 4090-4093, <https://doi.org/10.1145/3726302.3731685>

Conference demonstrations

- Takayanagi, T., Suzuki, M., Izumi, K., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R., Ounis, I. FinPersona: An LLM-Driven Conversational Agent for Personalized Financial Advising. *47th European Conference on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2025)*. Demo track. Lucca, Italy, April 2025, Vol. V, pp. 13-18, https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-88720-8_3
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Richards, E., McCreadie, R. FAR-AI: A Modular Platform for Investment Recommendation in the Financial Domain. *46th European Conference on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2024)*. Demo track. Glasgow, United Kingdom, March 2024, Vol. V, pp. 267-271, https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-56069-9_30

Workshop publications

- Guo, L., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R. Evaluating Knowledge Graph Sources for Non-Personalized Financial Asset Recommendation: 10K Reports vs. Wikipedia. *Knowledge-Enhanced Information Retrieval (KEIR 2025)*, pp. 120-150, October 2025, https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-02899-0_7
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Lever, J. Accelerating Cross-Encoders in Biomedical Entity Linking. *BioNLP 2025 and Shared Tasks Workshop co-located with the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2025)*, Vienna, Austria, August 2025, <https://aclanthology.org/2025.bionlp-1.13/> **2nd Prize Best Paper Award**.
- Guo, L., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R. University of Glasgow at the FinLLM Challenge Task: Adapting Llama for Financial News Abstractive Summarization. *Joint Workshop of the 8th Financial Technology and Natural Language Processing (FinNLP) and the 1st Agent AI for Scenario Planning (AgentScen) at the 33rd International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI 2024)*. Jeju, Republic of Korea, August 2024, pp. 127-132, <https://aclanthology.org/2024.finnlp-2.12/>
- Kim, Y., Lee, Y., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R., Lee, Y. Stock Recommendations for Individual Investors: A Temporal Graph Network Approach with Mean-variance Efficient Learning. *IJCAI 2024 Workshop on Recommender Systems in Finance (Fin-RecSys) at the 33rd International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI 2024)*. Jeju, Republic of Korea, August 2024
- Guo, L., **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R. Comparing the Impact of Financial Knowledge Graphs from Financial Reports and Wikidata in Asset Recommendation. *IJCAI 2024 Workshop on Recommender Systems in Finance (Fin-RecSys), at the 33rd International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI 2024)*. Jeju, Republic of Korea, August 2024.

- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Droukas, N., McCreadie, R. FAR-Trans: An Investment Dataset for Financial Asset Recommendation. *IJCAI 2024 Workshop on Recommender Systems in Finance (Fin-RecSys)*, at the 33rd International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI 2024). Jeju, Republic of Korea, August 2024, <https://arxiv.org/abs/2407.08692>
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, McCreadie, R., Droukas, N., Macdonald, C., Ounis, I. On Transaction-Based Metrics as a Proxy for Profitability of Financial Asset Recommendation. *3rd International Workshop on Personalization and Recommender Systems in Financial Services (FinRec 2022)* at the 16th ACM Conference on Recommender Systems (RecSys 2022). Seattle, Washington, USA, September 2022.
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Castells, P. Beyond Accuracy in Link Prediction. *3rd Workshop on Social Media for Personalization and Search (SoMePeAs 2019)* at the 41st European Conference on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2019). Cologne, Germany, April 2019, https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-52485-2_9
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Pepa, S.M., Castells, P. Structural Novelty and Diversity in Link Prediction. *9th International Workshop on Modelling Social Media (MSM 2018)* at The Web Conference (WWW 2018). Lyon, France, April 2018, <https://doi.org/10.1145/3184558.3191576>

Book chapter publications

- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Castells, P. Contact Recommendations in Social Networks. In: S. Berkovsky, I. Cantador, D. Tikk (Eds.): *Collaborative Recommendations: Algorithms, Practical Challenges and Applications*. World Scientific Publishing, November 2018. ISBN: 978-981-3275-35-5, pp. 519-570, https://doi.org/10.1142/9789813275355_0016

Other conference/workshop contributions without publication

- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Lever, J. Accelerating Cross-Encoders in Biomedical Entity Linking. University of Glasgow Computational Biology Conference. Poster. Glasgow, United Kingdom, September 2025. **Best poster award**.
- **Sanz-Cruzado, J.**, Angulo, P. Absorbing Markov Chains in Sage. III Jornadas Sage Python. Vigo, Spain, June 2012.

Teaching Experience

Lab teaching

- **Web search and data mining** *January to May 2018, 2019, 2020*
 - Universidad Autónoma de Madrid
 - 4th year Bsc Computer Science / 5th year Double BSc Computer Science & Mathematics
 - In Spanish
- **Analysis of algorithms** *September 2019 to January 2020*
 - Universidad Autónoma de Madrid
 - 2nd year Bsc Computer Science / 2nd year Double BSc Computer Science & Mathematics
 - In English

Guest lectures

- **Evaluation and production of recommender systems** *April 2022*
 - IE Business School
 - Course: Recommender Systems
 - Master's in data science and Big Data
 - In Spanish

- **Hybrid recommendation and learning to rank**

February 2025

- University of Glasgow
- Course: Recommender Systems
- Level 4 Course
- In English

Undergraduate student supervision

BSc thesis supervision (co-supervised with Prof. Pablo Castells, Universidad Autónoma de Madrid)

- Miranda, B. “Information Diffusion Modeling on Twitter” 2017-2018
- Amor, A. “Link prediction and recommendation in social networks” 2018-2019
- López, E. “Multi-armed Bandits in Recommendation” 2018-2019

Level 4 BSc thesis supervision (co-supervised with Dr. Richard McCreadie, University of Glasgow)

- Lunny, L. “iTrade: The financial portfolio generation tool” 2022-2023
- Mousa, J. “TradeMind: Developing Automatic Trading Strategies for Financial Markets” 2022-2023

Assistance with PhD student supervision

Main supervisor: Dr. Richard McCreadie, University of Glasgow

- Guo, L.: Universal information extraction and knowledge graph construction Since 2022
- Richards, E.: Constructive reasoning explanations using large language models Since 2022

Main supervisors: Prof. Iadh Ounis & Dr. Richard McCreadie, University of Glasgow

- Takayanagi, T.: LLM personalization for investment decision making June – December 2024

Main supervisors: Dr. Jake Lever, University of Glasgow, Prof. Obi Griffith & Prof. Malachi Griffith, Washington University in St. Louis

- Schimmelpfennig, L.: Biomedical information extraction using LLMs Since 2025

Participation in Research Projects

ClimInvest

November 2025 – Now

Reference number: 101212947

Creation of a dataset for risk assessment from green projects.

Institution: University of Glasgow

Partners: National Bank of Greece

Funding body: European Commission Horizon Europe

PI: Iadh Ounis, Craig Macdonald, Richard McCreadie

Role: post-doctoral research associate

Creation of a knowledgebase of high-quality assertions of the clinical actionability of somatic variants in cancer

August 2024 – August 2025

Reference number: U24CA275783

Automated information extraction from clinical research for the creation of a cancer knowledge base.

Institution: University of Glasgow

Funding body: National Cancer Institute (USA)

PI: Jake Lever

Role: post-doctoral researcher

ICURe Explore programme**October 2023 – January 2024**

Market analysis of the commercialization potential of a developed financial asset recommendation platform in previous projects (FAR-AI, PPC-FI and Infinitech).

Institution: University of Glasgow

Funding body: Innovate UK

Role: entrepreneurial lead

FAR-AI: Deployment of AI-Based Financial Asset Recommendation System

Reference number: EP/X525716/1

August 2023 – October 2023

Data collection of London Stock Exchange companies, and integration of the data on a financial asset recommendation and portfolio management platform for the UK market.

Institution: University of Glasgow

Funding body: UKRI EPSRC Impact Acceleration Account

PI: Javier Sanz-Cruzado

Role: primary investigator

PPC-FI: Personalized portfolio construction for financial investments **April 2023 – July 2023**

Reference number: EP/X525716/1

Development of automated portfolio construction and management algorithms and their integration within a financial recommendation platform for the Greek market.

Institution: University of Glasgow

Partners: National Bank of Greece

Funding body: UKRI EPSRC Impact Acceleration Account

PI: Javier Sanz-Cruzado

Role: primary investigator

Infinitech**November 2021 – March 2023**

Reference number: 856632

Research on recommendation technologies for the financial domain, and development of an investment recommendation platform for the Greek market.

Institution: University of Glasgow

Partners: National Bank of Greece

Funding body: European Commission Horizon 2020

PI: Iadh Ounis, Craig Macdonald, Richard McCreadie

Role: post-doctoral research associate

Beyond static recommendation: equity, interaction and transparency **June 2020 – May 2021**

Reference number: PID2019- 108965GB-I00

Research on people recommendation algorithms in online social networks.

Institution: Universidad Autónoma de Madrid

Funding body: Spanish Government

PI: Pablo Castells Azpilicueta, Iván Cantador

Role: pre-doctoral researcher

Recommendation in social media: context, diversity and algorithmic bias

Reference number: TIN2016-80630-P

December 2016 – December 2019

Research on people recommendation algorithms in online social networks and multi-armed bandit algorithms for recommendation.

Institution: Universidad Autónoma de Madrid

Funding body: Spanish Government

PI: Pablo Castells Azpilicueta, Iván Cantador

Role: pre-doctoral researcher

Voxpopuli: efficient analysis of reputation, propagation, and recommendation in social media environments

June 2014 – December 2016

Reference number: TIN2013-47090-C3-2-P

Research on people recommendation algorithms in online social networks.

Institution: Universidad Autónoma de Madrid

Funding body: Spanish Government

PI: Pablo Castells Azpilicueta

Role: pre-doctoral researcher

Languages

Spanish: Native Speaker.

English: Working proficiency.

- **Certificate of Advanced English** – Cambridge University *July 2018*
Level 2 Certificate in ESOL International.
Common European Framework of Reference (CEFR) C1 Level.
- **Graded Examination in Spoken English, Grade 11** – Trinity College London *June 2008*
Level 2 Certificate in ESOL International (Speaking and Listening). CEFR C1.2 level.

French: Basic notions.

Other Activities

Students' representation

- PhD students' representative in Computer Science department *2017 to 2021*
- BSc students' general delegate *2014 to 2015*
- Students' representative in "New Curricula" commission *2014 to 2015*
- Course delegate *2011 to 2016*

Software development and maintenance

- **RELISON framework:** Java social network analysis and recommender systems framework (<https://ir-uam.github.io/RELISON/>). *Since 2021*
- **RankSys framework:** Java recommender Systems framework (<http://ranksys.org>). *Since 2017*

Hackathons

- **Infinitech Hackathon** *16th-17th June 2022*
Team Infinithree – with Edward Richards and Lubingzhi Guo
Position: 1st
Developed profitability prediction algorithm with knowledge graph embeddings.
- **Infinitech Hack Challenge** *24th November 2021*
Team Infinithree – with Maanasa Shrikrishna and Edward Richards
Position: 1st
Developed profitability prediction algorithm with sentiment analysis extracted from news.

Invited talks

Information and slides for these talks are available at <https://javersanzcruza.github.io/talks>

- **Invited talk** at the Information Access and Retrieval in the AI Age workshop, at University of Glasgow Festival of Data Science and AI, titled "Accelerating Biomedical Entity Linking Models" (October 2025).

- **Invited talk** at the University of Glasgow IR seminars, titled “Accelerating Cross-Encoders for Biomedical Entity Linking” (September 2025)
- **Invited talk** at the University of Glasgow IR seminars, titled “Investors are (not) always right: A comparison of transaction-based and profitability-based evaluation in financial asset recommendation” (*June 2024*).
- **Invited talk** at the University of Glasgow IR seminars, titled “On Transaction-Based Metrics as a Proxy for Profitability of Financial Asset Recommendations” (*October 2022*).
- **Invited talk** at the University of Glasgow IR seminars, titled “Recommending people in social networks: algorithmic models and network diversity” (*February 2022*).
- **Invited talk** at the HaiVis group at the Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, titled “Contact recommendation in social networks using search methods” (in Spanish, *March 2021*).
- **Invited talk** at the Universidad Española de Educación a Distancia, titled “Contact recommendation in social networks: beyond accuracy” (in Spanish, *July 2018*).

Reviewer / Program Committee

- **Reviewer of** ACM Transactions on Information Systems journal (ACM TOIS).
- **Reviewer of** the User Modeling and User-Adapted Interaction journal (UMUAI).
- **Reviewer of** the ACM Transactions on the Web journal (ACM TWEB).
- **Reviewer of** the AI Communications journal.
- **Reviewer of** the Artificial Intelligence and Law journal
- **Reviewer of** the Scientometrics Journal
- **Program committee member** for European Conference on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2022, ECIR 2024, ECIR 2025, ECIR 2026).
- **Program committee member** for the ACM Conference on Web Search and Data Mining (WSDM 2026)
- **Program committee member** for the ACM Conference on AI in Finance (ICAIF 2024, ICAIF 2025)
- **Program committee member** for the ACM Conference on Recommender Systems (RecSys 2021, RecSys 2022, RecSys 2025)
- **Program committee member** for the ACM Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval (SIGIR 2022, SIGIR 2025).
- **Short paper program committee member** for the ACM Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval (SIGIR 2021, SIGIR 2024)
- **Short paper program committee member** for The Web Conference (WWW 2025)
- **Subreviewer** for The Web Conference (TheWebConf 2021).
- **Reviewer** for the latest-breaking results track for the 14th ACM Conference on Recommender Systems (RecSys 2020).

Organization

- **Local committee member / volunteer** at the 46th European Conference on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2024).
- **Organizer** of a workshop titled “What’s my next investment? Automated recommendations for investors?” at the University of Glasgow, as part of the Scottish Fintech Festival (*October 2023*).
- **Organizer** of the IR reading group at the University of Glasgow (*October 2022 – now*).
- **Local committee member** at the 42nd European Conference on Information Retrieval (ECIR 2020)
- **Student volunteer** at the 13th ACM Conference on Recommender Systems (RecSys 2019).

Other Interests and Hobbies

Videogames: PS5, Switch

Books: Science-fiction, fantasy

Table-top games: Dungeons & Dragons

Travelling

References

Prof. Pablo Castells

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Amazon

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Prof. Iadh Ounis

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University of Glasgow

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Prof. Craig Macdonald

Professor of Information Retrieval
University of Glasgow

E-mail: craig.macdonald@glasgow.ac.uk

Dr. Richard McCreadie

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Data Systems

University of Glasgow

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Dr. Jake Lever

Lecturer in Natural Language Processing and
Information Retrieval

University of Glasgow

E-mail : jake.lever@glasgow.ac.uk